THE ISLAMABAD OUTCOME TEXT

A MULTI-STAKEHOLDER POSITION TEXT FOR COP31



Negotiated and adopted at the Pre-COP31 Multi-stakeholder Consultation, Islamabad, 21 October 2026

Outcome Text | November 2026

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Note: This text records the positions of the institutions and organisations that took part. It does not represent the position of the Government of Pakistan

ISLAMABAD OUTCOME TEXT

Pre-COP31 Multi-stakeholder Consultation

Institute of Strategic Studies Islamabad | 21 October 2026

'As adopted'

The participants in the Pre-COP31 Multi-stakeholder Consultation, convened in Islamabad on 21 October 2026 by ClimateWatch, the Institute of Strategic Studies Islamabad and the Sustainable Development Policy Institute,

Preamble

PP1. *Recalling* that Pakistan submitted its third Nationally Determined Contribution in September 2025, committing to a 50 per cent reduction in projected 2035 emissions, of which 17 per cent is unconditional and 33 per cent conditional on international support, and identifying investment needs of USD 565.7 billion,

PP2. *Noting* that the Conference of the Parties will hold its thirty-first session in Antalya, Türkiye, from 9 to 20 November 2026, under a presidency arrangement between Türkiye and Australia,

PP3. *Recalling* that the Conference of the Parties at its thirtieth session called for efforts to triple adaptation finance by 2035, and *noting with concern* that the decision does not specify the baseline against which the tripling is to be measured,

PP4. *Noting* that adaptation finance provision reached USD 26 billion in 2023 against a commitment to reach USD 40 billion by 2025, and that the United Nations Environment Programme identifies an annual adaptation need of USD 310 billion through 2035,

PP5. *Noting* that the Fund responding to Loss and Damage has received approximately 176 eligible proposals from 119 countries seeking approximately USD 2.8 billion against approximately USD 342 million available for its pilot phase, that a ceiling of USD 20 million per proposal applies, that the Board deferred all allocation decisions to its meeting in December 2026, and that half of

the Fund's resources are reserved for least developed countries and small island developing States,

PP6. *Noting further* that Pakistan is classified neither as a least developed country nor as a small island developing State, and therefore competes for the unreserved portion of the Fund's resources with all other developing country Parties,

PP7. *Recalling* Pakistan's submission to the fourth meeting of the Transitional Committee, dated 10 September 2023, which held that all vulnerable developing countries must be eligible irrespective of their level of development and geographical grouping, and which warned against the earmarking of resources to some sub-funds at the cost of under-financing others,

PP8. *Recalling* that the Conference of the Parties at its thirtieth session established a mechanism on just transition, that terms of reference for the review of the United Arab Emirates Just Transition Work Programme were adopted at the sixty-fourth session of the subsidiary bodies, and that a decision on the continuation of the work programme is expected at the thirty-first session,

PP9. *Recalling* the dialogue on mountains and climate change under the Subsidiary Body for Scientific and Technological Advice, held in Bonn on 12 June 2026, co-facilitated by Bhutan and Switzerland, and required to report to the thirty-first session,

PP10. *Recognising* that the positions set out below are those of the participating institutions and organisations, and do not represent the position of the Government of Pakistan,

Section I. Just transition, including electrification and distributed renewable energy

1. *Calls for* the mechanism on just transition established at the thirtieth session to be operationalised at the thirty-first session as a fully constituted body, with the authority to develop guidance and recommendations and to support and monitor their implementation, and with clearly defined procedures for facilitating access to support, assessing gaps in support, and reporting on equity and human rights considerations;

2. *Affirms* that a just transition mechanism providing only dialogue and technical assistance would not respond to the needs of developing country Parties, and *calls for* the mechanism to have a defined relationship with the provision and disbursement of financial support, with transparent eligibility criteria, equitable access and public reporting;

3. *Notes* that Pakistan's energy transition is proceeding through household, community and institutional-scale solar deployment, largely self-financed and without a dedicated transition partnership or donor programme, so that the central just transition question for Pakistan is who is left out of a transition already under way and who bears the cost of the grid on which all users still depend; and *calls for* the just transition mechanism to recognise distributed and decentralised transition pathways, based on a locally suitable renewable energy mix including solar, hydropower and wind, as eligible for support on the same basis as utility-scale transition programmes;

4. *Notes* that affordability, rather than technical viability, is the principal barrier to an equitable transition, including for low-income households, farmers, and small and medium enterprises, and for communities in mountain regions where limited winter sunlight and the cost of storage constrain solar deployment; and *calls for* grant-based and concessional finance instruments designed for household and community-scale deployment of a locally suitable renewable energy mix, together with support for technical capacity in installation, maintenance and after-sales services, for local manufacturing, and for alternative livelihoods where the transition affects existing employment, with due regard to food security and agricultural livelihoods;

5. *Recalls* that the decision adopted at the thirtieth session on the just transition work programme contains no reference to unilateral trade measures, and *reaffirms* that the effects of such measures on developing country Parties, including on food security and fertiliser costs, remain unaddressed;

6. *Calls for* the review of the United Arab Emirates Just Transition Work Programme at the sixty-fifth session of the subsidiary bodies to assess the adequacy of support provided to developing country Parties, and not only the procedural functioning of the programme;

Section II. Adaptation finance

7. *Urges* the thirty-first session to specify the baseline against which the tripling of adaptation finance is measured as the average of 2022 to 2024, recalling the commitment made at the twenty-sixth session to at least double adaptation finance from 2019 levels by 2025, and to request the Standing Committee on Finance to report against that baseline from 2027;

8. *Notes with concern* that adaptation finance provision reached USD 26 billion in 2023 against a commitment of USD 40 billion by 2025 and an assessed annual need of USD 310 billion through 2035, and *calls for* the tripling commitment to be expressed as a provision target rather than a mobilisation target;

9. *Calls for* the Baku to Belém Roadmap to USD 1.3 trillion to specify the share of that total to be delivered as adaptation finance, for that share to be at least 50 per cent, and for grant-equivalent accounting to be applied to it;

10. *Notes* that the thirtieth session adopted 59 of the 100 proposed indicators under the Global Goal on Adaptation and provided that the indicators create no new financial obligations; *expresses concern* that an indicator framework without a corresponding finance obligation measures the adaptation gap without closing it; and *calls for* the indicators not to give rise to new reporting obligations for developing country Parties unless accompanied by the provision of finance and capacity-building support;

11. *Calls for* Pakistan's National Adaptation Plan, and the provincial and district adaptation plans developed under it, to be linked to its submissions to adaptation finance windows, and for project preparation capacity to be strengthened at the federal level and distributed to provincial, regional and district governments, including Gilgit-Baltistan, with resource mobilisation extending to the community level;

Section III. Loss and damage, including mountain communities

12. *Notes* that the Board of the Fund responding to Loss and Damage will consider its first package of projects in December 2026, after the thirty-first session has closed, and *urges* the thirty-first session to address the replenishment of the Fund on a needs-based cycle, rather than only its initial disbursement, with particular priority for loss and damage associated with the cryosphere;

13. *Expresses concern* that highly exposed developing countries that are neither least developed countries nor small island developing States, including middle-income countries such as Pakistan, compete for the unreserved half of the Fund's resources; *calls for* the overall capitalisation of the Fund to be increased so that the unreserved portion is adequate to the demand upon it; and *calls for* vulnerability-based and hazard-exposure-based allocation criteria, explicitly including cryosphere-related risks, to be applied to that unreserved portion;

14. *Calls for* delivery of the outstanding 45 per cent of pledges made to the Fund at the twenty-eighth session, and *calls for* a replenishment cycle with a defined target and timetable to be agreed at the thirty-first session, the target to be informed by the assessed scale of loss and damage needs across developing countries 10 Billion USD.

15. *Calls for* the ceiling of USD 20 million per proposal to be reviewed and raised to not less than USD 50 million where a proposal addresses transboundary or cascading hazards;

16. *Notes* the report of the dialogue on mountains and climate change to the thirty-first session, and *calls for* its recommendations to treat cascading mountain hazards, including glacial lake outburst floods, landslide lake outburst floods and debris flows, and their compounding by seismic activity in tectonically active ranges, as a distinct hazard class, being sudden-onset events produced by slow-onset change, and to establish a dedicated workstream on cryosphere loss and damage;

17. *Calls for* arrangements under the Fund that allow finance to reach subnational institutions and affected communities directly, including in mountainous and remote regions, irrespective of the administrative structures through which climate finance is ordinarily channelled, so that support reaches the last mile;

18. *Calls for* early warning coverage in mountain regions to be reported under the Global Goal on Adaptation indicator framework and addressed under the Early Warnings for All initiative with dedicated provision for cryosphere hazards, and *calls for* shared regional early warning arrangements across transboundary mountain basins that integrate satellite-based monitoring, local observation networks, communications connectivity to the last mile, and indigenous and community-based warning systems;

Section IV. Cross-cutting

19. *Calls for* Pakistan's delegation to the thirty-first session to include not fewer than two representatives nominated by youth organisations and by frontline community organisations, with full delegation status or, where that is not available, observer status;

20. *Calls for* a standing consultation mechanism through which subnational institutions, youth organisations and affected communities contribute evidence to Pakistan's negotiating positions ahead of each session, convened by the Ministry of Climate Change and Environmental Coordination;

21. *Requests* the conveners to transmit this text to the Ministry of Climate Change and Environmental Coordination and to the Ministry of Foreign Affairs by 1 November 2026, and to report back to participants on any response received before the opening of the thirty-first session.

Annex. Youth text

Tabled in Session IV alongside paragraphs 19 to 21.

Y1. *Not adopted. No coalition of Pakistani youth climate organisations yet exists to administer the proposed open call. The substance of youth representation on the delegation is reflected in paragraph 19.*

Y2. *Calls for* Pakistan's next Biennial Transparency Report to include a section reporting against the Glasgow work programme on Action for Climate Empowerment, prepared with the participation of youth organisations, and for youth organisations to be trained in transparency reporting and negotiating positions as a preparatory step;

Y3. *Calls for* the mechanism on just transition to name skills provision and labour market entry among its functions, and to refer explicitly to workers entering the labour market during the transition period, including young people and women entering the energy sector;

Y4. *Calls for* the share of adaptation finance reaching subnational and community-level implementers in Pakistan to be reported annually, disaggregated by age and sex of intended beneficiaries;

Y5. *Affirms* that intergenerational equity, as reflected in the preamble to the Paris Agreement, requires the cost of deferred adaptation to be assessed over the lifetime of the present under-30 population rather than over a budget or planning cycle;

Y6. *Calls for* youth representation in the governance of the Fund responding to Loss and Damage, through an active observer seat or a constituency-nominated adviser to the Board, and for the Ministry of Climate Change and Environmental Coordination to provide financial support enabling youth observers from Pakistan to attend meetings of the Board.

Adopted at the Institute of Strategic Studies Islamabad, 21 October 2026

Paragraphs 3, 4 and 16 were finalised by the conveners on the direction given in the room. One element remains in brackets, in paragraph 14.

Annex A. Record of proceedings

Convening

The Pre-COP31 Multi-stakeholder Consultation was held on Wednesday 21 October 2026 at the Institute of Strategic Studies Islamabad. It was convened by ClimateWatch, ISSI and SDPI in partnership with the Pakistan Red Crescent Society. Participants included UNFCCC negotiators, representatives of the United Nations Environment Programme, research institutes, civil society, environmental journalists, youth organisations and representatives of mountain and frontline communities.

Method

A draft Islamabad Outcome Text of twenty-one operative paragraphs, a preamble and a youth annex was circulated in advance. The room negotiated it paragraph by paragraph across four sessions, recording each paragraph as agreed, agreed as amended, to be redrafted, or not agreed. Where the room agreed the direction of a paragraph but asked for it to be rewritten, the conveners redrafted it on the basis of the interventions made, and those paragraphs are identified below.

Sessions

Session	Paragraphs	Chair and co-chair
Opening plenary	Items 1 and 2	Dr. Abid Qaiyum Suleri
Session I · Just transition	1 to 6	Dr. Khalid Waleed Ms. Saleha Qureshi
Session II · Adaptation finance	7 to 11	Dr. Zainab Ms. Neelam, SDPI
Session III · Loss and damage	12 to 18	Dr. Faisal Ali
Session IV · Cross-cutting and youth	19 to 21, Y1 to Y6	Ms. Mehnaz Mr. Ahmad Salik
Reading and adoption	Items 7 and 8	Dr. Zainab Ms. Mahrukh Khan

Disposition of each paragraph

Paragraph	Outcome	Note
PP1–PP2, PP4–PP5, PP8–PP9	Retained	Not separately discussed; retained as circulated.
PP3	Retained, shortened	Bracketed clause on mandate deleted by the conveners as unverified and not needed by paragraph 7.
PP6, PP7	Retained	Not separately discussed. Brackets removed by the conveners as factual recitals consistent with paragraph 13 as adopted.
PP10	Option 1 adopted	The text does not represent the position of the Government of Pakistan.
1	Agreed as amended	Option 1 by majority, extended to supporting and monitoring implementation, with defined procedures for access to support and for equity and human rights reporting. One youth participant preferred Option 2; one participant preferred Option 3.

Paragraph	Outcome	Note
2	Agreed as amended	Transparent eligibility criteria, equitable access and public reporting added; finance clarified as provision and disbursement.
3	Redrafted by conveners	Not agreed as circulated. “Substantially” deleted; solar-only framing replaced by a locally suitable renewable energy mix; self-financed character of Pakistan's transition recorded.
4	Redrafted by conveners	Not agreed as circulated. Grant-based instruments added; regional context, technical capacity, local manufacturing, food security and alternative livelihoods added.
5	Agreed as circulated	Capacity-building and domestic emissions trading points recorded in Annex B.
6	Agreed as amended	“Requests” replaced by “calls for”.
7	Agreed as amended	“Urges” retained; baseline set as the 2022–2024 average because 2025 data will not be available before 2027; Glasgow commitment recalled; Standing Committee on Finance reporting retained.
8	Agreed as circulated	
9	Agreed as amended	“No less than” replaced by “at least” 50 per cent.
10	Agreed as amended	Reporting obligations addressed. Drafted as a separate ask so as not to misstate the thirtieth session's decision.
11	Agreed as amended	District-level and community-level resource mobilisation added; provincial and district plans recognised.
12	Agreed as amended	Needs-based replenishment and priority for the cryosphere added.
13	Option 1 adopted, rephrased	Framing revised so as not to set Pakistan against least developed countries and small island developing States; capitalisation ask added; both criteria retained; cryosphere risk added.
14	Agreed in part	Pledge delivery and replenishment cycle agreed. Target figure not resolved; the room directed that it rest on global evidence of need rather than on Pakistan's national estimates.
15	Agreed as amended	Ceiling to be raised to not less than USD 50 million.
16	Redrafted by conveners	Not agreed as circulated. Glacial lake outburst floods broadened to cascading mountain hazards; workstream retained.
17	Agreed as amended	Place names replaced with mountainous and remote regions, to keep the text globally applicable.
18	Agreed as amended	Both reporting routes retained; shared regional arrangements, connectivity and indigenous systems added.
19	Agreed as amended	Not fewer than two; full delegation status or, where not available, observer status.
20	Agreed	Convened by the Ministry, rather than by the conveners of this consultation.
21	Agreed	Transmission date set at 1 November 2026.
Y1	Not adopted	No youth climate coalition yet exists to administer an open call.
Y2	Agreed as amended	Training of youth organisations added.
Y3	Agreed as amended	Young people and women entering the energy sector added.
Y4	Agreed	Disaggregation by age and sex.

Paragraph	Outcome	Note
Y5	Agreed as circulated	
Y6	Agreed as amended	Ministry financial support for youth observers added.

The heading of Section I was amended from “distributed solar” to “distributed renewable energy”, consistent with the room's decisions on paragraphs 3 and 4.

Themes that recurred across sessions

1. *Global language in the text, national detail in the briefings.* Participants agreed that negotiating text must be applicable within the positions of the Group of 77 and China, and that region-specific narratives belong in press briefings and side events. Annex B collects them.

2. *Affordability as the binding constraint,* across households, farmers, small enterprises and mountain communities.

3. *Implementation and accountability.* Participants repeatedly noted that recommendations and budgets from previous processes had not been implemented, and asked that delivery be tracked.

4. *Alignment.* Participants asked that the positions be aligned with the Group of 77 and China and the Like-Minded Developing Countries before Antalya.

Annex B. Context raised by participants

Points that participants agreed should be kept out of the negotiating text, but which may be useful in the Ministry's press briefings, pavilion events and bilateral meetings in Antalya. Figures are as presented in the room and should be verified before public use.

Just transition and energy

1. Pakistan's solar transition has been financed largely by households and businesses themselves. Participants cited around 51 GW of solar imported by March 2026, roughly 46 per cent of it rooftop or off-grid.

2. Three groups are most exposed: low-income households, because net billing shifts grid costs onto those who cannot adopt; mountain communities, where affordability rather than technology is the constraint; and industry and small enterprises, where the captive gas levy pushes firms onto a grid whose tariff carries cross-subsidies.

3. Rooftop solar has so far been concentrated among higher-income users.

4. In Gilgit-Baltistan, six to seven months of limited winter sunlight and the cost of lithium battery storage make solar alone unreliable. Run-of-river hydropower was identified as well suited to the region, with attention to siltation and downstream effects. Wind projects are at an early stage.

Unilateral trade measures

1. Compliance costs under the EU Carbon Border Adjustment Mechanism fall hardest on downstream small and medium enterprises in export supply chains, including textiles, cement, steel and sports goods, which lack capacity for life-cycle analysis and emissions reporting.

2. Participants raised the tension between such measures and common but differentiated responsibilities, and suggested that a domestic emissions trading system could strengthen Pakistan's position under the Mechanism and under Article 6.

Adaptation finance

1. Pakistan has costed national, provincial and district adaptation plans and a project pipeline developed with UNEP support under Green Climate Fund readiness. Participants urged that finance asks build on this pipeline rather than a parallel one.

2. District adaptation plans in Gilgit-Baltistan exist but lack ownership and implementation pathways.

3. On a straight-line path to the Glasgow target of USD 40 billion by 2025, adaptation finance in 2023 should have reached about USD 33 billion. It reached USD 26 billion.

Loss and damage and the mountains

1. Participants framed loss and damage as a question of climate justice supported by scientific and transboundary risk evidence, rather than as humanitarian assistance.

2. Glaciers in the Hindu Kush Himalaya lost mass about 65 per cent faster in 2011–2020 than in the previous decade. 2025 was the International Year of Glaciers' Preservation. Black carbon from regional sources accelerates melt.

3. The 2022 floods caused damages and losses of around USD 30 billion; recent mountain disasters in the region have run to several billion dollars each. Participants contrasted this with the Fund's current resources.

4. Participants urged coordination among Hindu Kush Himalayan countries and a fuller place for the cryosphere in the UNFCCC framework and the Global Stocktake.

Early warning

1. A participant reported that early warning systems installed in Gilgit-Baltistan under earlier projects did not function during recent incidents, while mobile phone calls warned communities in time. Communications connectivity was identified as a low-cost, high-value addition.

2. Community and indigenous practices, including announcements from mosques, are part of the warning system in mountain villages and should be integrated rather than replaced.

Youth and participation

1. No unified youth climate coalition yet exists in Pakistan, which is why Y1 was not adopted.

2. Youth observers accredited to meetings of the Fund's Board receive no travel support.

3. Participants asked for training of youth organisations on Biennial Transparency Report processes and on negotiation, as a preparatory step for future sessions.